ElitePublishing

BY ELITE PUBLISHING AGENCY

WOMEN'S EMPOWERMENT · NICHE RESEARCH

A bold self-worth series with your face on it

Reader demand, competition, comparable books, target audience and positioning for a direct, witty, tough-love self-help book for women, with a full concept for Book 1, a plan for Book 2 and an author-led cover direction.

01 Tough-love self-worth

02 Women 20–35

03 Two-book series

Prepared for
Mijke

Market
Amazon Kindle · Paperback

Date
October 2026

SUMMARY

Your idea works, and here is where it fits

You asked for a bold, feminine, slightly provocative self-development book for women. The tone you want is direct, challenging and witty, but genuinely empowering. It should have you on the cover, work as a two-part series and start from the title *"Your Insecurity Is Showing"*.

OUR RECOMMENDATION

Tough-love self-worth for women: Your Insecurity Is Showing

This is a short, punchy, voice-led guide of about 25,000 words for women aged 20–35, positioned as **"the big-sister reality check"**. Book 1 tears down insecurity, people-pleasing and comparison. Book 2, **Your Power Is Showing**, builds standards, confidence and self-respect. An author-led cover makes you the brand.

Key findings

Area	What we found	Verdict
Reader demand	Self-help is one of the strongest nonfiction categories, and women buy the large majority of it. Voice-led titles become the biggest hits.	**Strong**
Competition	The top of the category belongs to big names. The indie side is full of generic, faceless "confidence" titles with no recognisable voice.	**Medium**
The gap	The tough-love style is hugely popular on social media, but few *books* deliver it. That is where your opportunity is.	**Clear opening**
Length	Readers of this style want short, bingeable books. 20,000–30,000 words fits both the market and the tone.	**~25,000 words**
Series potential	The "breakdown, then build-up" structure turns naturally into two books with the same title pattern.	**Strong**
Author-led cover	A face on the cover works when the author *is* the voice, as with the bestselling women's titles we studied. Your photos give a strong base.	**Recommended** KEY ASSET

One important choice: we recommend developing **your own signature voice**, inspired by the energy of creators like Thewizardliz but never copying their catchphrases, persona or branding. A distinct voice is what makes the book feel original and lets it build its own audience.

THE MARKET

Women drive self-help, and voices drive sales

These figures come from industry sources and press reports. They show who buys self-help and what kind of book breaks through.

≈ 70%

of self-help book buyers are women

This makes women the core audience of the whole category, not a sub-segment.

Marketdata LLC (other sources put it at 74%)

2.8M

print copies of *The Let Them Theory* in 2025

It was the top-selling print book of 2025, and it is still #2 on the 2026 year-to-date chart, the only self-help title in the top 10.

Publishers Marketplace · Circana BookScan (via Quartz)

≈ 800K

print copies of *Girl, Wash Your Face* in its first year

This was a direct, personal, woman-to-woman book with the author on the cover. It was called "the publishing phenomenon of 2018".

Quartz, 2018

130+

weeks on the bestseller list for *You Are a Badass*

Its irreverent, funny tough-love tone kept selling for years, which shows that readers come back to this style.

Weekly bestseller lists (via WRAL archive)

What this means for your book

- **Readers buy voices, not topics.** The breakout titles in women's self-help are carried by a distinctive personality: frank, funny and personal. That is exactly the book you described.
- **Category sales follow strong new voices.** Self-help print sales grew in 2025 on the back of one breakout voice and cooled in the first half of 2026 as that book slowed (Publishers Weekly). Readers keep looking for the next voice that speaks to them.
- **The social-media style is under-served in books.** Thewizardliz's style is followed by a very large online audience, yet her own book (*The Wizardliz Guide to Inner Healing*, 2022) shows a modest footprint, with 184 ratings on Goodreads. The demand for this tone is far bigger than the supply of books written in it.
- **Short is a strength here.** Books in this style are often under 150 pages. Readers want a reality check they can read in a weekend and come back to.

COMPARABLE BOOKS

Who you are up against, and how they are positioned

We reviewed the big-name books readers compare everything to, and the indie titles you would sit next to on Amazon.

The benchmarks (big names)

Book	Positioning	Lesson for you
The Let Them Theory Mel Robbins	One simple, repeatable idea packaged as a "tool". The author's face and name are the brand.	A sticky core phrase sells the book.
Girl, Wash Your Face / Girl, Stop Apologizing Rachel Hollis	Each chapter names a lie women tell themselves. The author is on the cover, and the tone is personal and confessional.	A "call-out" chapter structure and an author-led cover.
You Are a Badass Jen Sincero	An irreverent, funny tough-love voice, with a bold typographic cover.	Humour makes the hard truths land.
Women Don't Owe You Pretty Florence Given	A provocative title and a bold visual identity aimed at young women.	Provocation plus empowerment works.
The Mountain Is You Brianna Wiest	Self-sabotage framed as something you can overcome. It is hugely shared on social media.	Quotable lines spread online.

The indie field (your direct neighbours on Amazon)

Title	What we observed
STOP BEING INSECURE 2026 release	It is keyword-led and generic in tone, with no visible author brand.
You're Not Too Much Stephanie Marin, 2026	A workbook format aimed at insecurity in relationships. It is gentle and therapeutic, not tough-love.
The Ultimate Glow Up Guide Elicia Goguen	It sells "glow-up" self-care and shadow work. Its Kindle rank was around #231,000 at the time of our check, which is modest.
"Dark feminine energy" titles 400+ Kindle results	This crowded corner leans towards seduction and "femme fatale" angles rather than self-worth.

The opening: the big names prove the demand but are not tough-love in the way you described. The indie titles target the same pain points but are mostly faceless, generic or soft. A book with a real face, a recognisable voice and a provocative title sits in a clear space between the two.

RECOMMENDED NICHE

Tough-love self-worth for women

Self-esteem and confidence, delivered with honesty and humour instead of gentleness. It fits Amazon's Self-Esteem, Personal Transformation and Motivational Self-Help categories.

Your target reader

Who she is

A woman aged 20–35 who lives on TikTok and Instagram. She follows glow-up and self-improvement creators and saves motivational quotes.

What she struggles with

People-pleasing, comparison, overthinking, situationships, seeking validation and a habit of shrinking herself.

What she wants

Someone who tells her the truth with no fluff, then shows her exactly how to become the woman she keeps pretending to be.

Your signature voice

> **"I'm not here to hold your hand. I'm here to hand you the mirror, and then the plan."**
>
> Sample line showing the intended tone: challenging first, empowering always.

DO

- ✓ Call out the **behaviour**, never the reader's worth
- ✓ Follow every "roast" with a practical tool or exercise
- ✓ Use humour, short sentences and quotable one-liners
- ✓ Share your own stories, since your memoir experience is an asset
- ✓ Talk like a big sister: honest because she cares

DON'T

- ✗ Copy other creators' catchphrases, slogans or persona
- ✗ Shame bodies, appearance or mental health
- ✗ Let the tone tip into cruelty without a way out
- ✗ Pad chapters with theory, because this reader wants punch
- ✗ Make promises the book can't keep ("change your life in 7 days")

A distinctive edge: a touch of European, Dutch-style directness ("we don't sugar-coat here") can become a signature that no competitor has, if you would like to bring that side of yourself into the brand.

BOOK 1

Your Insecurity Is Showing

Subtitle (draft): Stop Shrinking, Stop Seeking Approval, and Start Acting Like the Woman You Want to Be

THE PROMISE

Every chapter calls out one way insecurity quietly runs a woman's life, then hands her a clear, practical way to stop. It's funny, a little uncomfortable and impossible to put down.

Chapter outline (draft)

01 **You're Not Shy, You're Scared of Being Judged**
Where insecurity really comes from

02 **Stop Asking for Permission to Exist**
People-pleasing and over-apologising

03 **Your Group Chat Is Not Your Therapist**
Seeking validation and outsourcing decisions

04 **She's Not Your Competition**
Comparison and social-media envy

05 **Stop Dating Potential**
Situationships, standards and self-respect

06 **Your Body Is Not the Problem**
Appearance anxiety, without the fluff

07 **Overthinking Is Not a Personality**
Getting out of your head and into action

08 **Discipline Is the Highest Form of Self-Love**
Keeping promises to yourself

09 **Become Unbothered**
Boundaries, opinions and protecting your energy

10 **Main Character Energy, Done Right**
Confidence that doesn't need an audience

Each chapter ends with a **"Reality Check"**: three honest questions and one action for the week. This makes the book interactive and easy to share online.

Book specs

Length	**~25,000 words (≈ 130–150 pages)**
Formats	**Kindle ebook + paperback**
Suggested price	**$4.99 ebook · $12.99–14.99 paperback**

Categories	**Self-Esteem · Personal Transformation · Motivational**
Keywords	**self-esteem for women, stop being insecure**
More keywords	**confidence book for women, stop people pleasing**

BOOK 2 & SERIES

From breakdown to build-up

Book 1 tears down what holds the reader back, and Book 2 builds who she becomes. The shared title pattern makes the series instantly recognisable on Amazon.

THE "SHOWING" SERIES · BOOK 2

Your Power Is Showing

You stopped shrinking. Now it's time to take up space, on purpose.

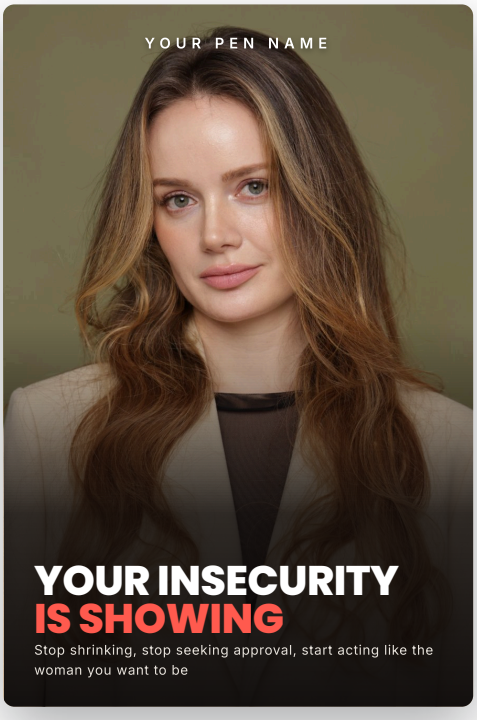
FOCUS

Standards, self-respect, feminine confidence, discipline, money and ambition, and how to hold your ground in dating, friendships and work, all in the same witty, challenging voice.

WHY A SERIES WORKS

Readers who finish Book 1 are primed for "what's next". The two books also cross-sell on the same Amazon pages and can later be offered as a bundle.

Author-led cover positioning



Positioning mockup made with one of your photos. This is not the final cover design. It shows how the author-led direction looks on a shelf.

- **Why your face:** in voice-led women's self-help, the author *is* the product. A face builds trust and recognition, as with the author-led bestsellers we reviewed.
- **Your photos:** they are professional, warm and elegant, with a direct gaze to camera, which is a strong base. For the final cover we would push the contrast and the type to make it bolder and more provocative.
- **Style:** very large uppercase title, one accent colour, a clean background and the same layout for Book 2, which keeps the series consistent.
- **Pen name:** consider using the same pen name as your memoir, so both books build *one* personal brand.

RECOMMENDATION

Our verdict: go for it

Your idea is not "cringe". It sits in a proven, women-led category, uses a tone readers actively seek out, and has a clear gap in book form. With a distinctive voice, a strong title and your face on the cover, ***Your Insecurity Is Showing*** has a well-defined place on the shelf, and ***Your Power Is Showing*** gives the series a natural second step.

What we recommend

Niche
Tough-love self-worth for women

Reader
Women aged 20–35, social-media native

Length
~25,000 words per book

Voice
Direct, witty, challenging and always empowering

Series
Two books with the same title pattern

Cover
Author-led, bold typography

How we move forward

1
Review
Tell us what you love or would change in the concept.

2
Quote
We send the production offer for Book 1.

3
Voice & outline
We define your voice guide and the chapter outline.

4
Write
We draft, edit and revise with your feedback.

5
Launch-ready
Final manuscript, then cover and listing.

Sources

- Publishers Marketplace: "2025: The New Bestsellers" (The Let Them Theory, 2.8M units)
- Quartz: "The 10 best-selling books of 2026 so far" (Circana BookScan)
- Publishers Weekly: "Print Book Sales Flat in First Half of 2026"
- Quartz (2018): "This self-help book is the publishing phenomenon of 2018"
- WRAL bestseller archive: weekly Advice & How-To lists
- Marketdata LLC / Gitnux: self-help industry statistics
- Goodreads: The Wizardliz Guide to Inner Healing
- Amazon.com: self-help and women's self-esteem listings (2026)

Market figures come from third-party and press sources and are given for guidance only. Niche research gives a better-informed starting point but cannot guarantee sales. Titles and creators mentioned as comparables belong to their respective authors and publishers. The cover mockup is a positioning illustration only.